

Maxwell Alan Hicks

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Entry-level Software Engineer (B.S. Software Engineering, Arizona State University, Cum Laude, 2025) who designs, builds, and ships full-stack applications end to end. On his Job Board Monitor project, built a Spring Boot service with scheduled jobs that acquire, normalize, and persist data to PostgreSQL through Spring Data JPA, with Flyway-managed, versioned schema migrations, structured into independently testable controller, service, and repository layers. On a separate REST API project, gathered requirements, designed the data model, then identified an over-engineered first design and refactored it into something simpler once it no longer fit the problem, a habit of testing his own assumptions rather than just his code. Comfortable across the stack: Java and Spring Boot on the backend, React and TypeScript on the front end, PostgreSQL for data, with hands-on exposure to AWS, Docker, and C/C++ from coursework. Has worked on a 5-person Agile team using Git-based branching, pull requests, and sprint ceremonies, and communicates clearly across technical and non-technical audiences daily while leading a 10+ person team through a high-volume, time-critical operation.

Skills

Languages: Java, Python, TypeScript, JavaScript, SQL, C/C++

Frameworks: Spring Boot, Spring Data JPA, REST APIs, React, Next.js, JUnit

Data & cloud: PostgreSQL, relational schema design, AWS (coursework), Docker

Practices: Agile/Scrum, Git/GitHub, code review, technical documentation, AI-assisted development (Claude, GitHub Copilot)

Projects

Job Board Monitor - Java, Spring Boot, Spring Data JPA, PostgreSQL, Flyway github.com/mahicks5/job-monitor

- Built a service that runs scheduled jobs to acquire, normalize, and persist data to PostgreSQL through Spring Data JPA, with Flyway-managed, versioned schema migrations.
- Structured the service into independently testable controller, service, and repository layers to keep components decoupled and easy to debug.

Tarot REST API - Java, Spring Boot, REST, SQL, Git github.com/mahicks5/tarot_api

- Designed a REST API from scratch, modeling the entity and defining the request/response schema and resource endpoints for a complete 78-record dataset.
- Identified an initial inheritance-based design as over-engineering for the dataset and refactored it into a simpler, more maintainable single-entity model.

Adaptive Virtual Assistant - Python, REST APIs, DeepSeek, Google Gemini

- Contributed backend logic on a 5-person Agile team, integrating multiple external LLM APIs into a working system through iterative design, coding, and testing cycles (code private per company agreement).

Portfolio Website - Next.js, TypeScript, Tailwind CSS, Vercel github.com/mahicks5/my-portfolio

- Designed, built, and deployed a production full-stack web application in TypeScript and React (Next.js), including a Java text-based dungeon crawler as an interactive project showcase.

Experience

Shift Supervisor, Starbucks - Louisville, CO Sep 2018 - Present

- Lead a team of 10+ in a high-volume location across variable shifts, prioritizing work in real time to hold service speed and quality steady.
- Act as the first point of contact for operational issues, diagnosing the problem and choosing the fix that fits under time pressure.
- Train and onboard new employees, breaking technical procedures into clear, repeatable instructions for non-technical staff.

Education

Arizona State University - B.S. in Software Engineering, Cum Laude, GPA 3.43 August 2025

Relevant coursework: Database Systems, Operating Systems (independent systems-level problem solving), Distributed Systems (AWS application deployment, client/server web services)